

Nikhil Bhandari

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Summary

Nine years across brand, growth and content for consumer and D2C businesses. Started in agency copywriting, moved client-side in 2019. Comfortable owning a channel end to end and equally comfortable being told the number did not move. Currently looking for a role with more ownership of organic and lifecycle and less of the events calendar.

Experience

Senior Marketing Manager · Hearth & Loom (D2C home textiles) · Mumbai · Mar 2022 – present

- Marketing lead for a business doing roughly ₹31 crore a year, about 64% of it through our own site and the rest through Amazon and Nykaa Fashion. Report to the founder. Team of four plus two agencies.
- Inherited a blog that had sat between 21,000 and 24,000 monthly sessions for nineteen months. Audited it, found 210 posts of which 60 had ever ranked, deleted or merged the rest, and rebuilt internal linking around eight buying guides. Sessions are now 78,000 a month and organic revenue roughly tripled.
- Rebuilt email from a single Friday newsletter into a twelve-flow lifecycle programme in Klaviyo. Welcome, browse abandon, cart abandon, post-purchase, replenishment, winback, VIP. Email went from 9% to 27% of site revenue, and revenue per subscriber from ₹62 to ₹191.
- Wrote every campaign email, landing page and ad for the first fourteen months before we hired a junior copywriter. Still write the flows.
- Instituted a monthly one-pager for the founder: what moved, what I think caused it, what I am changing. Two of those led to killing influencer seeding entirely and moving the budget into content production.
- Ran the 2023 and 2024 Diwali campaigns. Peak week revenue up 41% YoY. Managed a media budget of about ₹1.4 crore across the year.
- Sat on the packaging redesign committee and the ERP migration steering group. Neither was marketing work but somebody had to represent us.
- Interviewed and hired four people. Ran onboarding for two of them.

Marketing Manager · Copperfield Living · Mumbai · Jun 2019 – Feb 2022

- Second marketing hire at a furniture retailer with nine physical stores and a young online business. Grew online from 8% to 22% of total revenue.
- Owned the content calendar, the newsletter and the store-opening campaigns. Set up GA4 when Universal Analytics sunset was announced and rebuilt every report that broke.
- Managed a ₹60 lakh annual production budget and a roster of eleven freelancers: photographers, stylists, two writers and a video editor.
- Organised eighteen in-store events over three years, average footfall of about 340 per event.
- Ran the loyalty programme launch. 24,000 sign-ups in the first quarter, though retention on it was poor and I would do the incentive differently.

Senior Copywriter · Ampersand Creative · Mumbai · Aug 2016 – May 2019

- Agency side. Wrote for eleven accounts across FMCG, hospitality and one bank. Roughly 400 pieces of copy a year, everything from radio to packaging to long-form brand books.
- Led the pitch copy for four new business wins worth about ₹7 crore in billings.
- Mentored two junior writers.

Copywriter · Redgrove Advertising · Pune · Jul 2015 – Jul 2016

- First job. Print and radio for regional clients. Learned to take an edit.

Tools

Klaviyo, Ahrefs, Google Analytics 4, Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, Meta Business Suite, Shopify admin, Looker Studio, Figma (enough to resize things), Notion, Asana.

Education

BA English Literature, St. Xavier's College Mumbai, 2015
Google Analytics Individual Qualification, 2021 (lapsed)

Other

Volunteer copy help for a Mumbai animal shelter, roughly one weekend a month. Reasonable club-level badminton. Two cats.